Rodrigo Pacheco

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Columbia University 2021 – 2027 (expected)

M.S. in Economics, University of São Paulo 2021

B.E. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering, University of São Paulo 2016

Fields

Macroeconomics, Finance

References

Jennifer La'O
Columbia University
jenlao@columbia.edu

Hassan Afrouzi
Columbia University
ha2475@columbia.edu

Fernando Cirelli
Columbia University
f.cirelli@columbia.edu

Matthieu Gomez
Columbia University
matthieu.gomez@columbia.edu

Job Market Paper

Priced Out: Financing Frictions and Startup Mortality (with Madhav Malhotra)

Abstract. Startups raise equity in a sequence of financing rounds, and most of them are led by an investor new to the firm, who bargains with its current owners over the share of the firm it receives for the capital it provides. We ask whether investors' bargaining power causes inefficient startup failures and, if so, how many. We model equity financing as a dynamic game and show that inefficient failures arise precisely when future investors have bargaining power. Bargaining power at the current round only changes how the round's surplus is divided. However, those who decide whether to fund the firm today treat the surplus that future investors will capture as a loss, so they let firms that are worth funding fail. Using PitchBook data on US venture-backed startups, we find that in otherwise similar rounds, owners keep 1.85% less of the firm when a new investor, rather than a current owner, leads the round. The model identifies this gap as new investors' bargaining power. Although small, it causes 7.1% of startup failures, and six in ten of these firms would otherwise go public or be acquired.

Working Papers

When Does Disclosure Help? Information and Coordination in Equity Financing

Work in Progress

Bank Competition, Productivity and Inequality

Household Assets and the Job Ladder (with Madeline Hanson)

Other Publications

"Trade in Value-Added: Does MFN Status Matter for Colombian Regions?" (with R. P. Fernandes, I. F. Araújo, and E. A. Haddad). In *The Colombian Economy and Its Regional Structural Challenges*, Springer, 2023.

Teaching

Instructor, Columbia University

Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG) — Summer 2024, 2025, 2026

Teaching Assistant, Columbia University

Intermediate Macroeconomics (UG) — Five semesters, 2022 – 2025
Advanced Macroeconomics (UG) — Fall 2025
Macroeconomic Analysis II (M.A.) — Spring 2023

Teaching Assistant, University of São Paulo

Ph.D. core: Macro III–IV, Micro I–II, Real Analysis, Statistics — 2020

Teaching Development Program, Columbia Center for Teaching and Learning

Foundational Track — 2025

Awards and Fellowships

Presidential Award for Outstanding Teaching, Finalist, Columbia University — 2026
Ralph E. Holben Fellowship, Columbia University — 2024
Wueller Teaching Award, Runner-up, Columbia University — 2024
Wueller Teaching Award, Columbia University — 2023
Romão Mateus Award, Polytechnic School, University of São Paulo — 2014

Research and Work Experience

Research Assistant, Columbia University — 2024
For Fernando Cirelli and Christian Moser

Pricing Analyst, Itaú BBA, São Paulo — 2016 – 2018

- Developed pricing models and credit-risk simulations for corporate lending
- Trained commercial teams on risk-adjusted pricing methodology

Intern, Itaú BBA, São Paulo — 2014

Technical Skills

Programming: R, MATLAB, Python, Stata and Julia **Tools:** LaTeX, Git and MS Office

Personal

Citizenship: Brazilian **US Status:** F-1 Visa **Languages:** Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent)